Lindsey Mardona

UX DESIGN & RESEARCH

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — Expected Dec 2027 · Santa Cruz, CA
M.S. Human-Computer Interaction

Teaching Assistant, ART 101: lead two weekly sections teaching HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to beginner coders; designed exit tickets pairing confidence ratings with comprehension checks to guide reteaching.

University of California, Los Angeles — 2021–2023 · Los Angeles, CA
B.S. Cognitive Science, Specialization in Computing · Minors in Digital Humanities and Data Science Engineering · GPA 3.64

Diablo Valley College — 2019–2021 · Pleasant Hill, CA
A.S. Computer Science · A.S.-T Mathematics · A.A.-T Psychology · GPA 4.0

Certification Google UX Design Professional Certificate — Mentor Me Collective × Grow with Google Scholarship, 2025

Experience

UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute — Oct 2024 – Jun 2026
UI/UX Designer & Researcher (Contract) · Remote

- Sole designer on an **8-person team** building the **Latino Climate & Health Dashboard**—a first-of-its-kind tool mapping neighborhood-level extreme-heat and air-pollution disparities across Latino and non-Latino white communities in California; designed the web and mobile dashboards hosting the interactive county map and factsheets for **23 counties and the state**.
- Co-planned and analyzed a comprehension survey of **38 stakeholders**; found that **7 of 9 readers** who struggled with the map still rated themselves confident, and redesigned definitions, data callouts, and page layout in response. Tested every color pairing against WCAG AA.
- Partnered with a developer to ship the live product, reaching **~6,000 users**; covered by the **Los Angeles Times**, presented at the **NALEO** national conference, and the subject of a ***Health Affairs*** article (2026).
- Redesigned Latino Data Hub's Custom Graphs tool with an interactive tutorial and ran a site-wide usability audit; produced event/print collateral, InDesign layout reports, and policy toolkits for LPPI.

AAPI Movement Hub — Oct – Nov 2024
UX & Market Researcher (Contract) · Remote

- Partnered with one other researcher to analyze **3 years** of website analytics (**23K+ active users**) in Python, identifying traffic trends, top pages, user demographics, and acquisition channels.
- Investigated the **top 5 traffic spikes** by cross-referencing them with news and community events, and found that word of mouth and event promotion, not news cycles, drove most new-user growth.
- Audited prior interview research and competitors, then recommended prioritized UX improvements: refocusing underused resources with clearer labels and icons, and improving SEO for discoverability.

UCLA Political Science & Asian American Studies — Jun 2022 – Feb 2023
Web Designer & Developer · Los Angeles, CA

- Designed and built **UCLA MAAPP**, an interactive web map of Asian American political participation across LA County, in JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.
- Collaborated with a **7-person team** of political scientists and geographers to turn voter data on **5.6M registered voters** into **4 map views** (party registration, registration rate, turnout, and new voters) filterable by **5 district types** for targeted outreach.

Skills

Design	Interaction & motion design · Information architecture · User flows · Wireframing, wireflows & prototyping (lo-fi → hi-fi) · Design systems & components · Developer handoff · Responsive & mobile-first · Accessibility (WCAG) · Human-centered design · AI-assisted prototyping
Research	Usability testing · Interviews · Surveys · Contextual inquiry · Experiment Design (coursework) · Heuristic evaluation · Competitive analysis · Journey mapping · Personas
Tools	Figma · Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, After Effects) · Trello · Google Analytics · Tableau
Technical	HTML/CSS · JavaScript · Python · SQL · C++ · Java · Claude Code · Claude Design